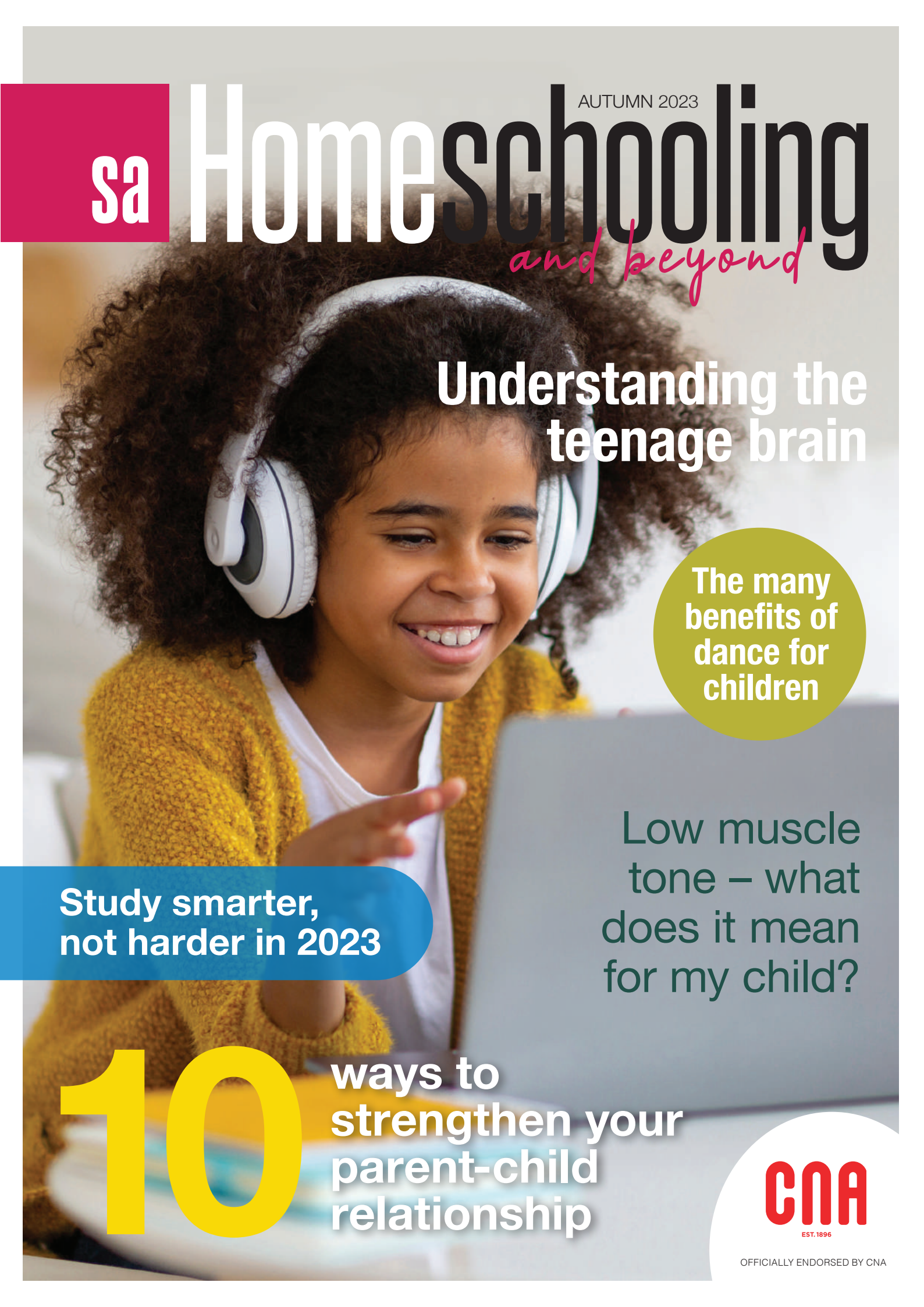




sa

AUTUMN 2023

Homeschooling *and beyond*

Understanding the teenage brain

The many
benefits of
dance for
children

Study smarter,
not harder in 2023

Low muscle
tone – what
does it mean
for my child?

10 ways to
strengthen your
parent-child
relationship

CNA
EST. 1896

OFFICIALLY ENDORSED BY CNA



MOORE HOUSE

- A C A D E M Y -



 **Cambridge Assessment
International Education**
Cambridge Associate

Affordable High School support with access to leading Universities in South Africa and Internationally.

Offering: GED, Cambridge IGCSE, Cambridge AS Level, Cambridge Lower Secondary, Social Emotional Learning, Remedial – Maths and English

REGISTER NOW FOR 2023!

**www.bostononline.co.za or
call 011-551-9111**



Benefits:

- Online
- Live and recorded classes
- Monitored progress
- Online does not mean alone - Counsellors available for support
- Registered Cambridge Assessor
- Interactive afternoon programmes for extra curricular
- Soul Candi Music Institute



UCT ONLINE
HIGH SCHOOL

Learning liberated.

Level up with South Africa's most recognised matriculation certificate.

Where your potential isn't defined by your postal code or the size of your wallet.



Enrol today for only

R2,195 pm*

*Subject to 2024 annual fee increase



SOUTH AFRICAN COMPREHENSIVE ASSESSMENT INSTITUTE
UID-AFRIKAANSE KOMPREHENSIEWE ASSESSERINGSINSTITUUT

**Learn global.
Stay local.**

The most affordable
Cambridge IGCSE in Africa.



Enrol today for only

R3,300 pm*

*Subject to 2024 annual fee increase



**Cambridge Assessment
International Education**

Cambridge International School

UCT Online High School is a registered
online Cambridge International School



8

Study smarter, not harder in 2023

With a new academic year upon us, let's help our children work smarter, not harder. Dalena van der Westhuizen, cognitive development specialist, master brain coach and co-founder and MD of BrainAbility, shares some tried and tested strategies.

10

How to organise your homeschool life

Organising your homeschool life can seem challenging, especially when you're schooling more than one child. If you're feeling overwhelmed, the best thing to do is take a deep breath and start with the basics. These tips will help you get organised.

14

10 ways to strengthen your parent-child relationship

Despite the best of intentions, parents can still fall short. Nurturing a harmonious relationship with your child takes effort, mutual respect and, above all, unconditional love.

17

Pinboard

Fun local events and outdoor activities in your city and nearby places for the whole family.

20

Quick lunches your whole family will love

It's easy to tire of making lunch every day, but being near your kitchen at lunchtime offers all sort of opportunities. These lunch ideas are sure to satisfy the entire family and are both easy to make and delicious!

Contents



24

Understanding the teenage brain

Dealing with pressure and stress is no small challenge for a fully mature brain, much less one that's in transition from childhood to adulthood. That's why it's important for parents to understand what their teens' brains are going through.

30

What does low muscle tone mean for your child?

While low muscle tone doesn't impact your child's mind or ability to learn, it can make activities associated with learning more difficult, such as gripping a pencil and staying seated for long periods.

34

Thriving in a digital economy

The way in which we work, as well as the future of the job market, are facing significant disruptions which are shaped by technology and the growth of artificial intelligence.

38

The many benefits of dance for children

If your child's looking for a fun, healthy activity, why not consider dance? There are many genres to explore in South Africa and through dancing, children increase their knowledge, skills and understanding of the world.

42

Ask Dalena

Dalena van der Westhuizen answers questions and concerns from parents about learning, concentration, memory, cognitive development – and, of course, the frustrations arising from these.

46

Disappointing matric results?

When the matric results are released, not everyone gets to celebrate the end of a successful high school experience. Some matriculants are excited to be starting their higher education journey, while others are unsure of what to do next.

49

Printable worksheets

Educational worksheets for foundation-phase children.





Sadly, we've all fallen victim to it: the comparison trap.

I bet that this comparison trap has been operating since the very first moms ever met one another.

We all have different strengths and weaknesses and we may be ok with them in theory, but we're often left feeling as if we fall short when we don't measure up to moms we see around us. Social media has made it even easier for us, as mothers, to see what we're not doing or doing wrong.

Many moms struggle with comparison. It's human nature to want to make sure we're in the "norm", especially when we're entering a new, unknown season of life that comes with a steep learning curve. But in our current culture, the "norm" has become a very specific mould that many people don't fit, making a lot of parents feel sub-par and discouraged.

"Comparison is the thief of joy" has become a cliché, but it's very true. We don't want to be so caught in the mom comparison trap that we miss out on what matters most!

More than ever, we need to resist the urge to compare ourselves (and our kids) with the people around us because no-one else can do our lives better than we can. Comparison is a choice and we can choose to *be* different and *think* differently.

Comparison is also deceptive. What looks like the "perfect mom" with "perfect children" to you, in conversation, may well be hiding a

slew of problems behind their front door which match, or exceed, your own. There's no such thing as a "perfect" mom or a "perfect" child. We're all just human beings, with human problems, doing our level best to give our kids the love, support and nurturing they need to grow into well-rounded adults.

Being a mom is, honestly, the most important job you'll ever have, but each child is unique, so each mother must be unique too. That "Stepford mom" you imagine, with her perfectly coiffed hair, unruffled demeanour and kids achieving ridiculously high marks in every subject, is a myth.

Combating comparisons in motherhood takes consciousness – and practice. But it's more than worth it.

As Oscar Wilde observed: "Be yourself. Everyone else is taken." And we'll add that you're perfect just the way you are.

Adri

Editor Adri Viviers | adri@isikhova.co.za

Managing Director Imraan Mahomed
imraan@isikhova.co.za

Director Jenny Justus
jenny@isikhova.co.za | 083 450 6052

Creative Director Joanne Brook
joanne@isikhova.co.za

Operations Director Thuli Majola
thuli@isikhova.co.za

Copy Editor Anne Phillips

Advertising Sales 011 883 4627

Recognised as a homeschooling stakeholder by the Department of Basic Education

Officially endorsed by CNA as its preferred homeschooling media partner

Subscriptions & General Enquiries:
sahomeschooling@isikhova.co.za

SA Homeschooling magazine is independently published by Isikhova Media (Pty) Ltd, 10th Floor, Metal Box, 25 Owl St, Milpark, Johannesburg, 2193, South Africa
Tel: 011 883 4627 | www.isikhova.co.za

The views expressed in this publication are not necessarily those of the owners, the publisher, contributors or their agents. While every effort has been made to ensure the accuracy of its contents, neither SA Homeschooling magazine, the owners, the editor, the publisher, media alliance partners nor any of its endorsed organisations or contributors can be held responsible for any omissions or errors; or for any misfortune, injury or damages which may arise therefrom. The same applies to all advertising. SA Homeschooling magazine © 2023. All rights reserved. No part of this magazine may be reproduced without prior written permission from the publishers.



savvy **thinkers**
smart **doers**
together **people**

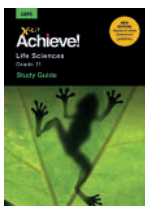
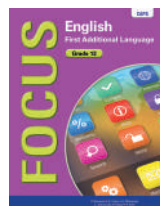
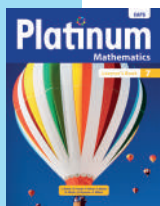


Learning for brighter futures

Pearson South Africa is now Maskew Miller Learning.

Maskew Miller Learning lends its name from the most trusted and recognisable publisher in South African learning – Maskew Miller.

Although our name and look may have changed, we still provide the same quality learning products and services that are meaningful to the local industry and make a real difference in the lives of learners.



 Learn more at mml.co.za

maskew miller
learning 

Study smarter, not harder in 2023



With a new academic year upon us, let's help our children work smarter, not harder. Dalena van der Westhuizen, cognitive development specialist, master brain coach and co-founder and MD of BrainAbility, shares some tried and tested strategies

Five top research-based study tips to make learning easier

1. Self-explanation

Come up with explanations, in your own words, of to-be-learnt concepts or ideas.

Rather than relying solely on precise provided definitions (eg from your textbooks or lessons),

create your own, while still making sure that they're accurate.

2. Use a timer

This is called the Pomodoro technique. Set a timer for 20-25 minutes and start studying. When the buzzer rings, take a five-minute break.

After two to three repetitions, take a 30-minute break. Repeat!

3. Interleaving

When studying, instead of focusing exclusively on one concept or subject at a time, alternate them.

For example, rather than studying only subject A on one day and only B on the next day, you can practise both on each day by switching back and forth between them.



4. Dig deeper

It's hard to remember a string of facts and figures if you don't push further. Ask questions like "Why?" and "How?"

This is called elaboration. Elaboration helps you combine new information with other things you know. It also creates a bigger network in your brain of things that relate to one another.

That larger network makes it easier to learn and remember things.

5. Be the "teacher"

Research shows that pupils have better memory and recall abilities when they learn new information with the expectation of having to teach/explain it to someone else.

Studies also suggest that pupils are more engaged and will instinctively seek out methods of recall and organisation when expected to take on a "teacher" role.

"Research shows that students have better memory and recall abilities when they learn new information with the expectation of having to teach/explain it to someone else."

Things to remember for your work/study space

- 1 **Switch off your cellphone** When working or studying, your phone can be the biggest source of distraction, affecting your focus and time management. So switch it off or set it on airplane mode. Don't just put it on silent because you'll be tempted to keep looking at it whenever there's a new message or e-mail notification. It's best not to have your phone with you while you study.



- 2 **Keep it simple** For the most efficient, distraction-free use of your work/study space, keep only the things you use daily within reach (no extras, only what's really needed and used regularly). Store everything else away from your desk.

- 3 **Keep your planning in sight** Put up a visual calendar where you can write down important tasks, due dates for tasks/projects, etc. Knowing and visually seeing what's next makes planning for it easier and reduces anxiety.

- 4 **Make the clock work for you** When studying, a wall/desk clock can be your best friend or your worst

enemy. Keeping an eye on the time gives a sense of urgency, but can also distract you from the work you're busy with. Use the clock to your advantage by setting time-related goals (use the Pomodoro technique). Before starting to study, set a timer for how long you plan to do it. Each time you resume studying after a short break, set it again.





How to organise your homeschool life

Organising your homeschool life can seem challenging, especially if you're homeschooling more than one child. If you're feeling overwhelmed, the best thing to do is take a deep breath and start with the basics. These tips will help you get and remain organised

If you're just starting out in homeschooling, or are turning over a new leaf this school year, it's always good to spend some time coming up with an organisational system that will help keep your homeschool life running smoothly.

These organisational ideas and simple tips will help you enjoy your homeschooling journey and your time with your kids a lot more.

1

Create a designated learning space

Create a designated learning space where you can avoid distractions. This could be an entire room, a desk in your bedroom or space at the dining room table. Having a specific space set aside to complete a given task makes it easier to focus on it. It also creates some separation

between “home time” and “school time”, which makes it easier for your child to transition to and from schoolwork.



2 Follow a daily schedule

Homeschooling adds a wonderful level of flexibility and spontaneity to children's education. However, without a clear structure, it's easy to get distracted and go off track. Kids thrive when they have a basic structure and routine. Consider creating and following a daily schedule. You can always adapt it, but a schedule will give you focus and direction each day.

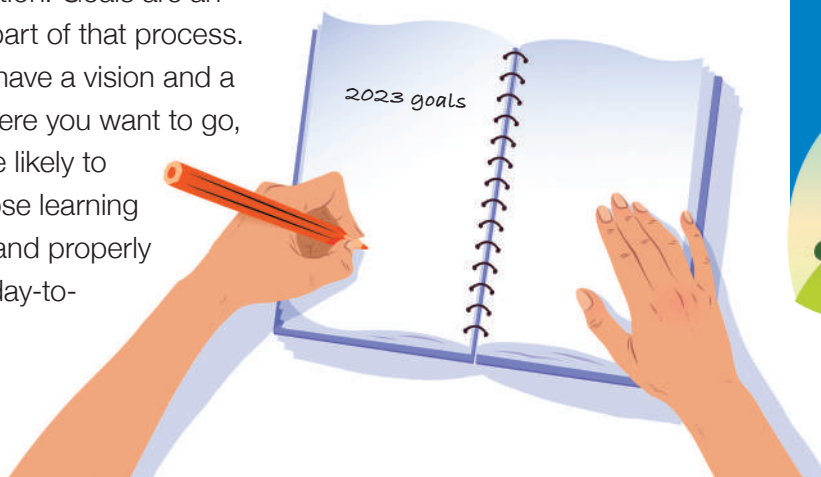


3 Planners are your friends Using a planner is one of the best ways to keep your life organised. There are many to choose from, so select one that meets your needs. Always keep your planner in the same place for you and your child to see. Get an overview of the big picture of your child's semester or year by filling in important deadlines, tests and projects. Being reminded of these dates will help your child stay focused on their goals.



4 Set learning goals together Homeschooling gives your child the opportunity to direct and customise their education. Goals are an important part of that process. When you have a vision and a plan for where you want to go, you're more likely to achieve those learning outcomes and properly align your day-to-

day curriculum. As the parent/teacher, outline some key learning objectives for your child ahead of time. (These will likely be based on state or national requirements, your personal educational philosophy, as well as your child's age and abilities.) Once you have some broad objectives and benchmarks, sit down with your child and get their input.



5 Take regular breaks Set lesson times and encourage frequent breaks, with the opportunity for some physical recreation to get the blood pumping. Give your child a nudge to spend some time outside so that they can walk, run, play and let off steam. Children's attention span increases with age, so while a younger child might need a short break every 10-15 minutes, an older one or teenager would only need a break after a full lesson block of 40 minutes. Be mindful of this when planning your day.



6 Tackle the hard subjects first If your children are struggling with certain subjects, such as maths or science, have them do those in the morning when you're all more alert. Save the easier subjects for later in the day.



7 Declutter and clean up Set aside time for your child to clean up their study space at the end of their day. Have them put away any binders, textbooks or materials. Any papers or supplies that aren't currently being worked on should be put away. This will keep their space neat and clutter-free.



“These organisational ideas and simple tips will help you enjoy your homeschool journey and your time with your kids a whole lot more.”

8 Don't take on too much Agreeing to too many things such as extracurricular activities can leave you and your kids tired and overwhelmed. Participate in what really matters to your family

and evaluate your commitments throughout the year to see whether something should be dropped.

9 Realise that the curriculum's there to serve you Use it as a guide instead of a master. You're in control of your homeschooling, not your lesson plans or suggested daily schedule.

Being organised will help you set yourself up for success. We're cheering you on as you take steps towards bringing greater order to your homeschooling days. It will be worth it!



* INTELLECTUAL * CAPS ALIGNED * INSPIRES LIFELONG LEARNING



Supernova

The mag for curious kids

SUPERNOVA
MAGAZINE TAKES
YOU AND YOUR
FAMILY ON A
JOURNEY OF
DISCOVERY!

PUBLISHED IN
SOUTH AFRICA FOR
PRE-TEENS, IT'S
DESIGNED TO INCREASE
READING SKILLS AND
CREATE A SAFE,
FUN SPACE FOR
LEARNING.

GET YOUR
NEW ISSUE
EVERY 2
MONTHS.



**SIGN UP
TODAY**

CHOOSE A SUBSCRIPTION
OPTION THAT SUITS YOU.



10

ways to strengthen your parent-child relationship

Despite the best of intentions, parents can still fall short. Nurturing a harmonious relationship with your child takes effort, mutual respect and, most importantly, unconditional love.

Being a parent isn't about doing everything right – it's about showing your children how much you love them through your actions, listening to them when they need someone to talk to and being there when they need a helping hand.

Here are 10 ways to strengthen your parent-child relationship:

1 Tell them and show them that you love them

Human touch and loving affection are needed at every stage of our lives for healthy emotional and neurobiological development. It's important that

“Treat every interaction as an opportunity to connect with your child. Greet them with warm expressions, make eye contact, smile and encourage honest interaction.”

your child receives gentle, loving physical contact (hugs) from you. Treat every interaction as an opportunity to connect with your child. Greet them with warm expressions, make eye contact, smile and encourage honest interaction. Tell your children you love them every day, no matter what their age. Even on difficult days or after disagreements, make sure your children know that although you didn't like

their behaviour, you love them unconditionally.

2 Spend quality time together What better way to spend quality time together than doing an activity you all enjoy? You could start a family business, join your kids in sports or simply create memories that last. It's a great investment in your child's future and will strengthen your parent-child relationship for years to come. Your children need you. If they have a healthy relationship with their parents, they'll be more likely to cope with stressful situations in life.

3 Communication is vital Communication is a big part of any strong relationship and your parent-child relationship is no different. Sometimes you may need to approach your child about their behaviour or health concerns. At



other times, you might want to ask them how their day was. Whatever it is you want to talk about to them, make sure that you and your spouse/partner are both ready and willing to have conversations with your kids.

4 Words of affirmation Building a strong parent-child relationship includes the words you use to communicate. If you still believe that children should be seen and not heard, you'll miss out on their growing brain, the interesting things they think about and how they interact with those around them. As a parent, you have the opportunity many times a day to use words of encouragement that will build a strong relationship with your child.

GOOD JOB!

5 Check in with each other One of the most effective ways of strengthening a parent-child relationship is by spending some one-on-one time together every day. This doesn't have to be a long sit-down – even



a quick check-in about how each of your days has been is important. Frequency is more important than duration: think quality over quantity. Start your check-in by asking: "How was your day? What did you get done? Did anything go wrong or not as you planned?" Asking these questions will allow both you and your child to share your experiences without judgement or being interrupted and will reinforce your bond.

6 Eat together Ensure that you eat at least one meal a day together as a family. This provides opportunities to talk about your day, your interests, who you interacted with, what challenges your children are



rules are broken, make sure that there are age-appropriate consequences in place and be consistent in applying them.

10 Respect children's choices You may not like your child's mismatched shirt and shorts or the way they've placed pictures in their room. However, it's important to respect those choices. Children strive for independence at a young age and parents can help foster their decision-making skills by being

facing, what things made them happy/sad and much more. It also provides time to work together preparing the meal, laying and clearing the table, putting the food away, doing the dishes and cleaning the kitchen. This is prime time for additional conversation and showing the value of working together.

7 Be available and distraction-free Setting aside time each day to talk to your child, without distractions, can make a big difference in establishing good communication habits. Turn off the TV and put away your cellphone and other electronic devices. Your child needs to know that they're a bigger priority in your life than any of the distractions and stressors you're facing.

8 Let your children help you Parents sometimes inadvertently miss

opportunities for closeness by not allowing their child to help them with various tasks and chores. Unloading groceries after going shopping is a good example of something kids of most ages can and should help do. Children feel powerful when they help. They also feel more valued when asked their opinions (eg, "Which shoes would look better with my dress?"). Remember, though, that once they've given their opinion, you may have to accept and live with their choice!



Set boundaries, rules and consequences

Children need structure and guidance as they grow and learn about the world around them. Talk to them about what you expect of them and make sure they understand. When



supportive and even looking the other way on occasion. After all, it really is OK if your child goes shopping with you wearing a striped green shirt and pink plaid shorts.

Make time for family activities, keep the lines of communication open, have fun with your

kids as often as possible and you'll strengthen your parent-child relationship!



Play Africa children's museum

Located at Constitution Hill, Braamfontein in Johannesburg, [Play Africa](#) is one of SA's first dedicated children's museums offering an educational experience that is centred entirely around creative play.

A broadly inclusive space designed especially for young families (children with mental or physical disabilities are also well accommodated), Play Africa offers hands-on and creative experiences with an

educational element, covering topics from arts and ecology to engineering, literacy and geography. Visitors are advised to book online in advance. Entrance is free, although donations are appreciated.



Mitchell Park, Morningside, Durban

Not only does [Mitchell Park](#) have a magical tropical setting, but it offers a variety of activities for the whole family. You can relax on spacious lawns while the kids play on jungle gyms, swings and slides. Located near trendy Florida Road, it has a lovely tea garden and the famous mini-zoo, home to various birds, monkeys, crocodiles and Admiral, the ancient tortoise which has lived in the park since 1915! There's a walk-through aviary for bird-lovers and if you're lucky, you might even spot the elusive bush babies.



Pinboard

Fun local events and outdoor activities in your city and nearby places for the whole family

Berry-picking at Bon-Af Berry Farm

The Bon-Af Berry Farm on the Free State side of the Vaal River, near the town of Parys, offers berry-picking in season, from November to April. It's great fun – and, of course, the whole family gets to enjoy the delicious fruits of their labour! The outing includes a guided tour of the orchard, as well as the chance to pick a variety of berries, including blackberries, gooseberries, elderberries, raspberries, blackcurrants and black nightshade. You'll be given a special container to hold your harvest. There's also

a tea garden on the premises which serves refreshments, as well as a petting zoo with cute farm animals. Also be sure to visit the little museum with its displays of everyday items, including a dress that dates back 125 years and a firearm and phonograph from 1889.



It takes a digital village to raise a child in the digital age

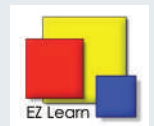
It's why we emphasise collaboration so strongly. It's why we are so focused on partnerships and relationships. Between Digitutors, EZ Learn, DT International Academy, and Born To Learn. Between you, the parent, and us, the experts. Between the tutors and the students. Between you and your child.

In the modern digital village, we have access to the minds, skills, and experience of people from all over the

world – we bring it right into your home. Exceptional partnerships, innovative teaching methods, experienced (and enthusiastic!) tutors, and personalised small group lessons bring all the power of the digital village to your child's education needs.

We deliver British International Curriculum preparing students for GCSE, AS and A level examinations opening doors to tertiary and further education around the world.

MEET THE PARTNERS



1. Digitutors | Catherine Cuff

With qualifications in Education and Psychology, and over 25 years of experience Catherine Cuff heads up the team at Digitutors. She has a passion for Maths and Physics and for uncovering the potential of each student by understanding them as a person with their unique strengths and challenges.

WWW.DIGITUTORS.CO.ZA



2. Born To Learn | Wilna Smith

Wilna Smith has 27 years' experience in teaching computer-related subjects at government and private schools in South Africa. She has extensive knowledge of the IEB as well as British International GCSE and AS-level curriculums and is able to teach up to A-level.

WWW.BORNTOLEARN.CO.ZA



3. DT International Academy | Danie Boneschans

Danie completed his BA in Audiovisual Production Management and thereafter his PGCE at the University of Johannesburg. Danie has been teaching Afrikaans for over 14 years and has developed a series of online programs assisting students to achieve their best results in Afrikaans.

WWW.DANIETEACH.COM



4. EZ Learn | Barbara Williamson

Barbara founded EZ Learn based on the dream of providing lessons and resources that are easy and interesting to use. Since 2001 EZ Learn has aimed to make commercial subjects easy, relevant and fun for both students and teachers.

WWW.EZLEARN.CO.ZA

For a full solution, guidance or even just some advice, contact us on admin@digitutors.co.za or whatsapp 082 604 7318 and join our Digital Village today.

Collaboration is key to our children's futures

In a world that is seemingly filled with knowledge that can be accessed with the swipe of a finger or the touch of a button, how do we ensure our children are getting the resources, time, and education they need?

The collaboration between Digitutors, EZ Learn, DT International Academy, and Born To Learn takes the best of this digital world and creates a specialised digital village dedicated to the support and education of your children.

A class apart

What sets us apart is how we structure the learning process. Small group online classes, private lessons, personalised learning paths, and best of breed educators in an interactive and engaging environment are what we bring to give your children an environment that stimulates and encourages.

Your children, our students

But our partnerships go beyond the classroom. You, the parents, are an integral part of the learning experience. Whether you feel you have taught them as much as you are able to or are exploring homeschooling as an alternative to crowded traditional schools or are in a remote area with limited



access to educational facilities, you can be assured that we have your children's best interest at heart – and that means working closely with you.

Feedback, one-on-ones, progress updates, and advice on subjects and future options all go hand-in-hand with the lessons to create an optimal pathway to your children's success.

A life lesson

We offer a full range of subjects to our students but, rather than cramming as many pupils into a room as can fit, we bring the lessons into your home with small group online classes and private lessons. Our model ensures that every student benefits from a personalised lesson and is able to interact and engage with their tutor and

their subject instilling a love of learning into your children.

By tailoring the curriculum to your children's interests and needs for further education we can concentrate on getting them the grades they need for success rather than dumping an overwhelming load of information that will never be used again.

Join our digital village and get the support you and your children need

All it takes is a camera-enabled device, a secure internet connection, and a willingness to give your children a head-start in a digital world and they will get the brightest and most enthusiastic tutors, plus the best educational support this digital world can offer. Join our village of support today.

It's easy to tire of making lunch every day, but being near your kitchen at lunchtime offers all kinds of opportunities. These lunch ideas are sure to satisfy the entire family and are both easy to make and delicious!

Skip making the same old lunches every day. Chef and mom-of-four Anri Fourie shares these yummy and easy-to-make lunch recipes that you and your family will really enjoy.

Biltong and cheese savoury muffins

Preparation time: 15 mins

Cooking time: 20 mins



Ingredients:

130g biltong, finely chopped
45g (3T) margarine, melted
500ml (2 cups) self-raising flour
30ml (2T) sugar
2 eggs
250ml (1 cup) milk
250ml (1 cup) Cheddar cheese, grated
45ml (3T) Bovril
15ml (1T) chopped parsley

What else you'll need:

A muffin pan
2 medium-sized mixing bowls
1 big spoon to mix



Quick lunches
your whole
family will love



Method:

- Pre-heat oven to 190°C.
- Spray the muffin pan with Spray and Cook.
- Mix the melted butter and parsley together and set aside to cool.
- In a separate bowl, combine the eggs, milk and Bovril. Mix well.
- Add the butter and parsley mixture to the egg mixture, mixing well.
- Add the grated cheese and biltong to the mixture, mixing well.
- Using the big spoon, fold the self-raising flour into the mixture.
- Using a tablespoon, fill each muffin hole in the pan halfway up with the mixture.
- Bake until golden-brown (approximately 20 mins). Then remove the muffins from the pan and allow them to cool before serving.

French toast with a twist

Preparation time: 10 mins

Cooking time: 5 mins

Ingredients:

- 2 eggs
- 2 slices bread
- 30ml (2T) milk
- 15ml (1T) oil for frying
- A pinch of salt

For the filling:

- 62ml (¼ cup) Cheddar cheese, grated
- Two slices tomato
- 2 slices ham (or bacon)

What else you'll need:

- A frying pan
- A mixing bowl
- A spatula
- A plate for serving

Method:

- Beat the eggs, milk and salt together.
- Dip the bread slices in the egg mixture, turning to coat both sides.
- Add oil to the frying pan and heat to a medium heat.
- Add the bread slices to the pan, frying each of them for about 2 minutes per side, or until golden-brown.
- Place a bread slice on the plate and stack with the cheese, tomato and ham. Close the sandwich with the other slice of bread.





Anri Fourie, owner of two guesthouses and mom of an eight-year-old daughter and four-

year-old triplets, cooks meals that are quick and easy to make – with multiple little helping hands. In the Fourie household, family time is a great time to cook together. As the former owner of a coffee shop, Anri used to share the kitchen with skilled chefs. Today she shares it with her four busy little offspring, who're all eager to pitch in and help.

Tuna and mango salad

Preparation time: 15 mins

Cooking time: 10 mins

Ingredients:

1 mango, cut into 1cm cubes
200g lettuce, finely chopped
½ cucumber, diced
150g cherry tomatoes, halved
4 large pickles, diced
2 boiled eggs
340g tuna, drained
2 spring onions, finely chopped
Salt and pepper to taste
62ml (¼ cup) finely chopped chives for garnishing

For the dressing:

Mix together:

185ml (¾ cup) mayonnaise
62ml (¼ cup) sweet chilli sauce
5ml (1 tsp) lemon juice

What else you'll need:

A chopping board
A knife
2 x mixing bowls
A small cooking pot

Method:

- Mix together the lettuce, cucumber, tomatoes and mango pieces and transfer to a plate or serving bowl.
- In a separate bowl, mix together the tuna and spring onion with the dressing mixture.
- Using a spoon, place the tuna mixture on top of the salad.
- Cut the boiled eggs into quarters and arrange on top of the salad.
- Garnish with chopped chives.



Yummy smoothie

In a smoothie-maker, mix together the following:

2 bananas, chopped
30ml (2T) peanut butter
62ml (¼ cup) yoghurt of your choice



Note: This salad can also be served in a wrap or on top of a slice of bread.



ACADEMIC COACHES
BEYOND TUTORING

Similar to a sports coach, Academic Coaches focus on skills and strategies in support of the long-term academic success of a learner.

www.academiccoaches.co.za @myacademiccoaches



Join our premium cognitive development programs!
Test & Strengthen memory, learning, reading and attention skills.

www.brainability.co.za

ONLINE
1-on-1 sessions
OR IN-CENTRE




All natural ingredients

Sinuses can hinder studying and school progress...

Breathe Beta
Pure Essential Oil Inhale &, Vapourizing Rub



Understanding the teenage brain

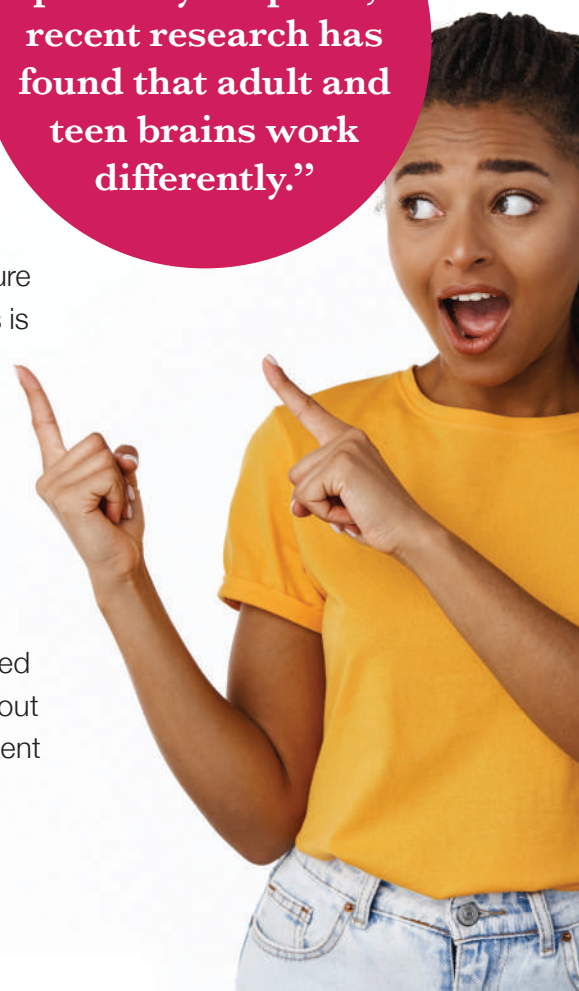
“As every parent of a teenager probably suspects, recent research has found that adult and teen brains work differently.”

Dealing with pressure and stress is no small challenge for a fully mature brain, much less one that’s in transition from childhood to adulthood. That’s why it’s important for parents to understand what their children’s brains are going through. Dalena van der Westhuizen, cognitive development specialist, master brain coach and co-founder and MD of BrainAbility, shares some insights

“**T**eenager” – the mere mention of the word can spark *lo-o-o-ng* conversations about the good, the bad and even the ugly of parenting an adolescent. One thing I know for sure from working with so many families is that being the parent of a teenager isn’t easy. Nor is being one.

I never really comprehended this until I, too, became the mother of a teenager.

Let me be perfectly honest: I’m writing this article because I wanted to see if I could miraculously find out more about how my own adolescent son’s brain works.

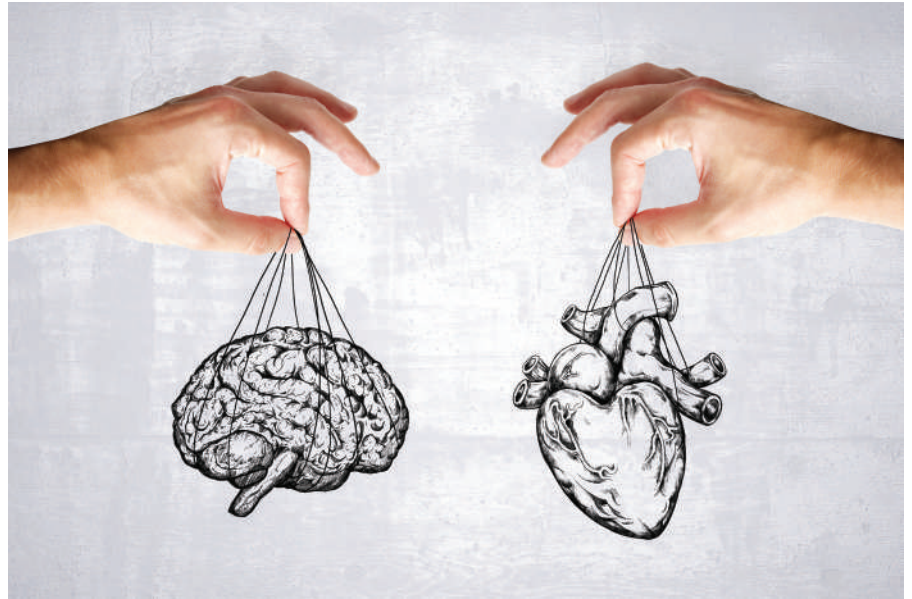


It's so much easier dealing with other parents' children who we've witnessed growing up into adolescence. Yet, when it comes to our own, we're so busy juggling all the demands of work and home that it feels as if they've somehow turned into teenagers overnight. We simply can't remember at what point that actually happened.

Perhaps, like me, you look at this strange-yet-familiar-know-it-all-but-still-have-so-much-to-learn young person in front of you and oscillate between pride in the individual they're about to become and sorrow because you want them to remain a child a little longer.

Let's take this journey together and delve into what research tells us about the teenage brain.

- Significant changes occur in the brain from the ages of 12-25.
- The brain is known to have a high degree of neuroplasticity, which refers to its lifelong ability to adapt and change. This simply means that the teenage years are an exceptionally good period in which to tap into neuroplasticity and improve the way the brain processes, retains and recalls information.



- As every parent of a teenager probably suspects, recent research has found that adult and teen brains work differently:
 - o Adults think with the prefrontal cortex, the brain's rational part which responds to situations with good judgement and an awareness of long-term consequences.
 - o Teens, on the other hand, process information with the amygdala. This is the emotional part of the brain.



- In teens' brains, the connections between the emotional part and the decision-making centre are still developing – and not always at the same rate.
- The rational part of a teen's brain isn't yet fully developed and will only be so at the age of about 25. This is why, when teens have an overwhelmingly emotional response to a person or situation, they're later unable to explain what they were thinking. In fact, they weren't thinking as much as feeling.
- While a teen's brain is developing, they might:
 - o take more risks or take part in high-risk activities;
 - o express more and stronger emotions;
 - o make impulsive decisions.

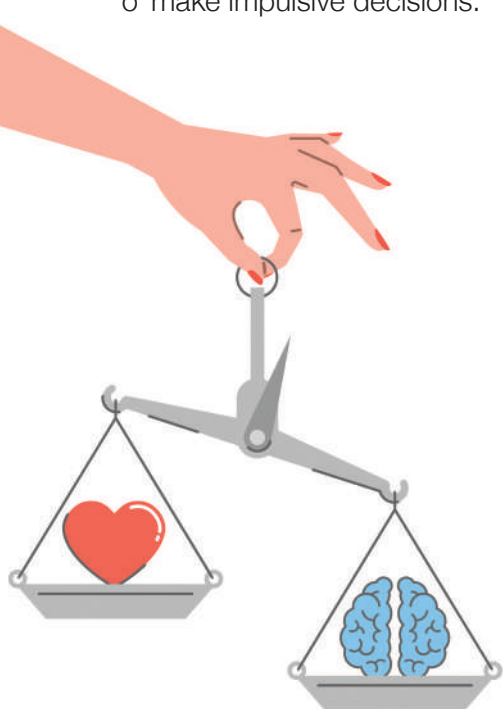


- Sleep is an important part of learning. Research has repeatedly confirmed that getting enough sleep every night is extremely important for a teenager (although your teenager will vehemently disagree). Recent studies have shown that a huge percentage of teenagers are sleep-deprived and have highlighted the negative effect this has on their development, learning ability and emotional regulation.

So what's a parent to do?

Here are some tips for encouraging good behaviour and strengthening positive brain connections:

- 1 Remind your teen that they're resilient and competent. Since they're so focused on the moment, adolescents have trouble realising that they can play a part in changing bad situations. Remind them of times in the past that they thought would be devastating, but turned out for the best.
- 2 Discussing the consequences of their actions can help teens link impulsive thinking to facts. This helps the brain make these connections and wires it to create them more often.



3 Become familiar with things that are important to your teen. You don't have to like their taste in music, movies and fashion, but showing an interest in the things they're involved in tells them that they're important to you.

4 When your teen comes to you with a problem, ask whether they want you to respond or simply listen. You'll be surprised at the difference this approach makes to your conversations and your teen's willingness to open up to you about things with which they're struggling.

5 The way teenagers spend their time is crucial to brain development. The combination of your child's unique brain and environment influences the way they act, think, learn and feel. It's very important to keep your teenager's brain challenged and exposed to different situations in which they can grow and improve.

6 You're an important part of your child's environment. The way you guide and influence them will help them build a healthy self-esteem (and brain). Be a positive role model. Your own behaviour will demonstrate the behaviour you expect from them.

7 Let your child take some healthy risks. New and different experiences help your child develop an independent

identity and strengthen their ability to handle different situations with confidence.

8 Help your child find new creative and expressive outlets for their new (and strong) feelings, many of which are influenced by their hormonal development, which is activating their sexual identity. Many teenagers find that taking part in or watching sport, as well as listening to music, writing and other art forms, are good channels for their emotions.

9 Talk through decisions step by step with your child. Ask about possible courses of action your child might choose and talk them through the potential consequences. Encourage your teen to weigh up positive consequences or rewards against negative ones.

10 Use family routines to give your teen's life some

structure. These might be based around academic and family timetables.

11 Provide boundaries and opportunities for negotiating those boundaries. Teens need guidance and limit-setting from their parents and other adults.

12 Spend some alone time with your teen every now and again. Make sure you're available and in the moment (so put that cellphone away!). Here it's about the quality of the time spent together, not the quantity, so make every moment count!

13 Talk to your child about his/her developing brain. Understanding this important period of growth might help them process their feelings.

I hope you enjoy this exciting, scary, exhausting – but thoroughly wonderful and rewarding – journey we're on with our teenagers!



Your ideal choice for your homeschool curriculum

What does Educ8 SA have to offer?

Educ8 SA is an online curriculum provider offering teaching excellence and a broad curriculum at an affordable price. Quality online education that is affordable, flexible, and personalized for all students from Pre-School to Grade 12.

Educ8 SA was established in 2017 due to a gap in the South African Education market for students and families with unique needs and circumstances seeking an innovative learning environment. Today, we have students enrolled all over the country as well as in other parts of the world. Students who desire more flexibility and choice can design a learning plan to suit their needs.

Learning about the history of Educ8 SA

Haelene has more than 22 years of teaching experience and homeschooled her own four children. Being a veteran homeschooling mom truly helped her understand the ins and outs of homeschooling and each student's unique needs. She had years of experience and knowledge to offer to all newbies and to those who have been homeschooling for a while.

What were the biggest accomplishments?

The testimonies of graduated students absolutely speak for themselves. We are known for the super service and support we provide to our parents and students! This is so important as it establishes trust; without trust, we won't have clients.



What's one of the hardest things that Haelene faced with being a business owner?

The energy, blood, sweat, and tears that go into each day - like with any business, nothing comes

easy, but it is so worth the time and effort!

What curriculum options does Educ8 SA have to offer?

We have many different options:

- Grade K - Gr. 8: R400
- American High School Diploma (Gr. 9 - 12): R1600

(All resources, assessments, and tests included - no hidden costs)

- GED: R500/student package/month
- GED Exam FEE: \$80/subject - 4 Subjects
- Individual Student Registration Fee: R1000 per student or R1500 per Family

Where can your business be found online?

Website: <https://www.educ8sa.com/> or
Facebook: <https://www.facebook.com/educ8sa/>

Contact Educ8 SA today!

Hannes / Haelene

info@educ8sa.net

www.educ8sa.com

084 685 2138



Educ8 SA

Improving lives through learning

DISCOVER THE POWER OF INDIVIDUALIZED LEARNING



WHAT WE OFFER

- Handpicked, award-winning curricula.
- Online interactive learning resources.
- Preschool - Gr .12.
- FREE placement tests.
- Online tutorials.
- Online assessments, tests & exams.
- Parent progress monitoring & reporting.
- Find & fix learning gaps.
- Student motivational tools.
- Can be used as full curriculum or supplementary.

**Quality Education
that is Affordable,
Flexible and
Personalized**

www.educ8sa.com

info@educ8sa.net

084 685 2138

**14-DAY
FREE TRIAL**

A group of children are standing on a wooden balance beam in a grassy field. The child in the foreground is a young girl with a large afro hairstyle, wearing a white t-shirt and grey shorts, balancing with her arms outstretched. Behind her, several other children are also on the beam, some wearing colorful clothing like a red shirt and a pink skirt. The background is filled with lush green trees under a clear blue sky.

Low muscle tone, or hypotonia, refers to decreased tension in a muscle when it's at rest. Your child might feel floppy or it may feel as if you're picking up a child who's sleeping, even though they're awake. Children with low muscle tone may also tire more easily because it takes more energy to use their muscles

“While low muscle tone doesn't impact your child's mind or ability to learn, it can make activities associated with learning more difficult.”

What does low muscle tone mean for your child?

Low muscle tone goes by a variety of different names: hypotonia, weak muscle tone, floppy baby syndrome or floppy infant syndrome.

Muscle tone and muscle strength aren't the same thing, as your child can have strong muscles, but still have low tone. Low muscle tone is neurologically based and generally can't be changed. However, children can strengthen their muscles through occupational therapy and learn to compensate for low tone so that they function better in their daily activities.

There are three categories of muscle tone: normal tone, high tone and low tone.

Normal tone refers to the "just right" amount of tension inside the muscle during rest. Primarily, the muscle's able to contract on command – ie, your muscle does what you want it to do,



when you want. It also refers to the appropriate amount of force being utilised when performing specific movements.

High tone refers to an excessive amount of tension in the muscle during rest. The muscle is portrayed as "tight" and "tense" when not performing any movements.

Low muscle tone occurs when the length of the resting muscle is slightly longer than typical. This means that the muscle fibres aren't overlapping at an optimal level and there are fewer points where they can attach and generate pull on the muscle. As a result, the child needs to go through a greater range of motion, so more energy's used.

A child diagnosed with low muscle tone will face certain challenges with functional skills. These could include sitting upright while working at a table or desk, or playing games that require



them to perform short bursts of running. Many kids with low muscle tone will also tire easily and quickly from performing routine tasks such as walking up a flight of stairs.

It's important to remember that muscle tone is a spectrum and that each child is impacted differently. For some kids, it's a mild nuisance. For others, it's an obstacle that has a significant influence on daily life.

Common signs of low muscle tone:

- Increased flexibility in their joints.
- Poor posture.
- Poor balance.
- Frustration with physically challenging tasks.
- Awkward, tight pencil grasp.
- Becoming fatigued easily.
- Preference for engaging in sedentary activities.
- Slouching when seated.
- Difficulty sitting upright for long periods (ie tabletop activities).
- Difficulty maintaining head control (eg, holding their head in their hands when writing or reading).

“It’s important to remember that muscle tone is a spectrum and that each child is impacted differently.”



- Difficulty changing positions (eg rolling, sitting and standing).
- Clumsy or unco-ordinated movements.
- Hand-eye co-ordination difficulties.
- Poor reflexes.
- Walking with a wide base.
- Delayed gross motor skills development (crawling, jumping, etc).
- Delayed fine motor skills development (grabbing toys, moving objects between hands, etc).



Low muscle tone can be associated with various syndromes and diagnoses. However, it can also be present in a child without any other diagnoses, in which case the cause is unknown. More than 600 medical conditions have been linked to low muscle tone, but finding the root cause isn't guaranteed – even with testing.

While low muscle tone doesn't impact your child's mind or ability to learn, it can make activities associated with learning more difficult, such as gripping a pencil or remaining seated for long periods.

Fortunately, there are various treatment programmes available to help your child increase their muscle strength and

overall sensory stimuli, provided the cause of their condition is confirmed. These programmes typically involve physical therapy through a school-based or early intervention programme, alongside other forms of therapy.

Opting for programmes that are family-centric is also a good idea, so that it's more fun and enjoyable for your child. This will encourage them to committing to doing the exercises, staying fit and constantly improving their strength.

How can you help your child?

The ability to create and sustain a

muscle contraction is essential for motor skills, co-ordination skills and balance skills to develop.

First and foremost, be patient. Some children with low muscle tone may take a little longer to learn new motor skills than their peers do. Encourage them to keep trying and praise small accomplishments.

For extracurricular activities, try swimming, karate, gymnastics or other sports that build overall muscle strength. Focus on improving core muscle strength and hand strength as well. During leisure time, play fun games that incorporate physical activity, such as practising animal walks or doing obstacle courses.

Once a child learns a new skill, allow them ample practice time to fully master it.

While doing schoolwork, a child with low muscle tone may have trouble maintaining an upright posture. Some children may need a supportive chair or cushion to help maintain proper posture. During floorwork, try having the child lie on their stomach or sit in a chair so that they don't experience muscle fatigue.

There'll be good days ahead, as well as some bad ones. However, keep reminding yourself that every tiny step forward is real progress.



Thriving in a digital economy

The way in which we work, and the future of work itself, are facing significant disruptions that are being shaped by technology and the innovative growth of artificial intelligence

According to a report by the World Economic Forum (WEF), the rapid adoption of these technologies, in everything from manufacturing to healthcare, is opening up new opportunities for workers with the skills needed to thrive in the digital economy. In the USA, for example, online job postings for digital roles increased by 24% between 2018 and 2021, led by a 116%

increase in the number of listings seeking data engineers. Postings for computer scientists rose by 72%, followed by increases of 70% in advertisements for chief investment officers and directors of IT, 63% for data scientists and 55% for marketing specialists.

Moving closer to home, the advance of technologies such as machine learning, artificial intelligence and advanced robotics will have a far-reaching impact on SA's workplaces. Although digitisation will be disruptive, it has the potential to raise productivity and operational efficiency in businesses across sectors, to deliver better outcomes for both customers and citizens, and to create millions of high-quality jobs. A McKinsey report points out that digitisation could create as many as 1,2 million jobs by 2030.

"This poses two significant challenges to higher education institutions," says Prof Zaheer Hamid, Director of the MANCOSA

"Digitisation could result in demand for an additional 1,7 million employees with higher education by 2030."

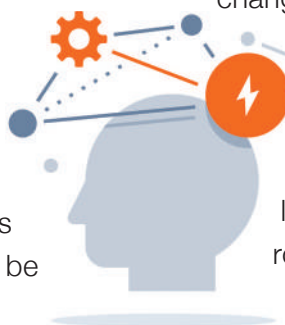
School of Education. “How do higher education institutions prepare courses that are future-focused, and how do these institutions prepare their students for the hyper-competitive and ever-changing job market?”

Transferable skills

The WEF report points out that continuous change means continuous investments in the digitisation of the labour market.

Identifying the occupations that will thrive as the market evolves – and the skills needed to perform these roles – will allow policymakers and employers to focus education and training on the skills and tools that workers need to succeed.

“So what are these skills? Not only are companies entering a new business world, but employees are also expected to be adaptable and have



transferable skills that can be used in many different parts of the organisation. Examples of this are people management, change management and diversity management. Employers are no longer placing employees in specific boxes, limiting them to a specific role in the organisation,” says Hamid.



The changing landscape

The report adds that because technology’s having such a big influence on the future of work, unique jobs will exist in the future that didn’t exist 10 years ago. Here are some examples:

- Online job postings for data scientists in Canada, the UK and the USA increased more than 40 times between 2012 and 2021.
- Demand for cybersecurity professionals has boomed in recent years, as more firms gather data to inform decision-making.
- Demand for IT professionals and technicians to manage IT infrastructures is rising across all countries, partly due to the increase in connectivity of all types of businesses and activities.

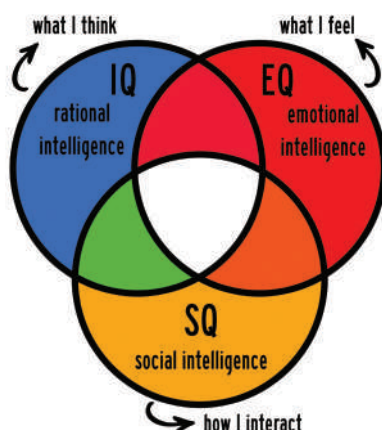


- Software developers and engineers are more in demand, thanks to the rise of e-commerce, online sales and the use of apps.

Because of this, the WEF report points out that there's a dramatically increased demand for specific skills.

- The knowledge of machine learning, data science and data visualisation is spreading extremely quickly across roles and sectors. In the USA, demand for advanced data analysis skills spread more than 15 times faster than demand for the average skill between 2012 and 2021.
- A rapidly rising number of businesses are looking for people with social media management skills. In the UK and the USA, the demand for social media skills spread up to 14 times faster than the demand for average skills between 2012 and 2021.
- Digital jobs require a mix of technical and high-level cognitive skills.

Again, moving closer to home, the McKinsey report points out that new technology-enabled jobs in SA will require higher skill levels than most of the jobs that will be displaced by digitisation. In fact, digitisation could result in demand for an additional



1,7 million employees with higher education by 2030. Unless a higher percentage of SA's graduates take technology-related jobs, much of that demand will go unmet – resulting in a serious skill shortfall across the economy.

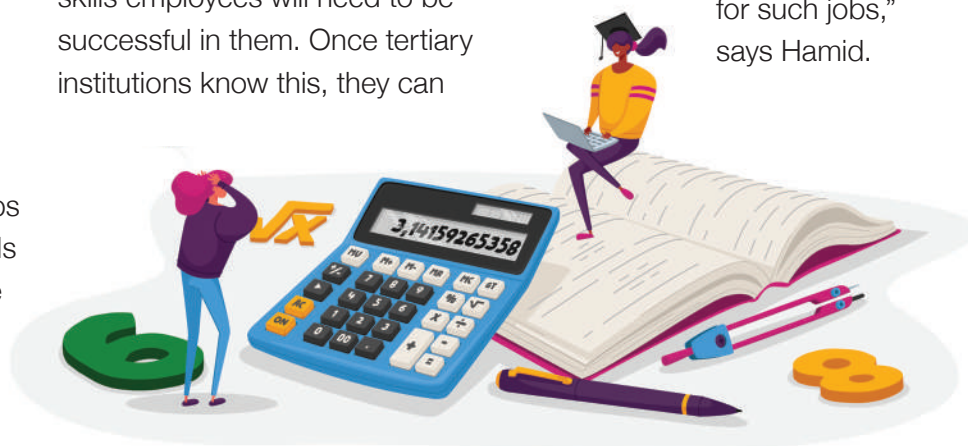
“How do tertiary education institutions respond to this? First, we need to know where our students come from and the context that brought them to where they are. We also have to know what they need to succeed. The last piece of this puzzle means having a deep understanding of what the future job market's going to be like, the jobs that will be available in the future and the skills employees will need to be successful in them. Once tertiary institutions know this, they can

design innovative, cutting-edge courses and schools that will adequately prepare students for life after university,” says Hamid.

Important decisions

Pupils in high school will be required to make subject choices based on what they believe will be the best career for them when they enter the labour market. Some pupils will change their minds about their career choice and will thus have to pivot in their chosen high school subjects. Hamid has some key advice for these students.

“Core subjects such as language and numeracy skills will be a key component for any job. Pupils need to sit down with guidance counsellors and possibly people who've already entered the job market and find out what skills are needed to be successful. Make school subject and university course choices based on this information, rather than on what looks good on paper. Another key driver of these choices will be the future demand for such jobs,” says Hamid.



ONLINE ACCESS

ASSESSMENTS

ACCREDITATION

RETHINK YOUR EDUCATION

Adapt your child's education to suit their needs as well as yours.

WHY US? We bridge the gap for all children who wish to work towards obtaining an accredited National Senior Certificate through distance education.

GET TO KNOW US Home-schooling is a challenging task to undertake at a high school level all alone.

Since 2015, Moore House Tutor Academy has provided educational assistance to learners who choose an alternative educational approach, while still adhering to the traditional paths towards a National Senior Certificate. The attention to our learners' whole learning experience is our primary driving force.

We hope to afford the learners the opportunity to change the way they learn. Memorising content is still a large part of our educational system but it does not mean that learning the content must be traditional.

CONTACT US

+27 107 460 236

info@moorehouse.co.za

3 Bultfontein Farm,
Middel Road,
Northern Farms,
Lanseria, 1739





The many benefits of dance for children

If your child's looking for a fun, healthy activity, why not consider dancing? There are many types of it to explore in SA and through dance, children increase their knowledge, skills and understanding of the world

South Africa has a long history of using dance as an expression of all aspects of life. From warriors with spears and shields to miners doing gumboot dances, to the beautiful modern choreography many companies offer today, dance has always been important to our country's peoples.

According to Dance Facts, there are over 42 different styles of dance. In SA, these range from classical (ballet) to ballroom, Spanish, line dancing, tap, break dancing, salsa, modern (jazz, hip-hop, contemporary dance) to traditional forms. Most children enjoy and thrive in the dance classroom.

“When kids participate in dance classes and increase their level of physical fitness, they feel more positive emotionally and mentally.”

Participation in different types of dancing offers many benefits for children:

Dancing strengthens the body

Dancing is an incredible exercise and is so much fun that when kids are doing it, they don't feel as if they're doing a traditional workout. Dance's physical benefits include cardiovascular, muscle and strength development, plus increased stamina, endurance and blood

flow. Since it also improves flexibility and co-ordination, dancing can help children become less prone to injuries. It also helps them sleep better at night.

Dancing improves punctuality, social skills and teamwork

Actively participating in dance classes teaches kids to be punctual. On top of that, dancing with new kids and groups will not only help them make new friends, but improve their social skills. Time management skills will help them to achieve their desired goals, while friendly social interactions are necessary for their emotional development.

Dance classes also offer a great opportunity for kids to develop teamwork skills. Certain genres require them to perform in pairs or groups, which encourages co-operation, observation, a feeling of inclusivity and a sense of purpose.

Dance classes can help a child's emotional well-being

When kids participate in dance classes and increase their level of physical fitness, they feel better emotionally and mentally. Exercise releases chemicals called endorphins that trigger positive feelings. Dance also encourages kids to release their inhibitions and gain confidence, as well as developing a more positive self-image. Since it also



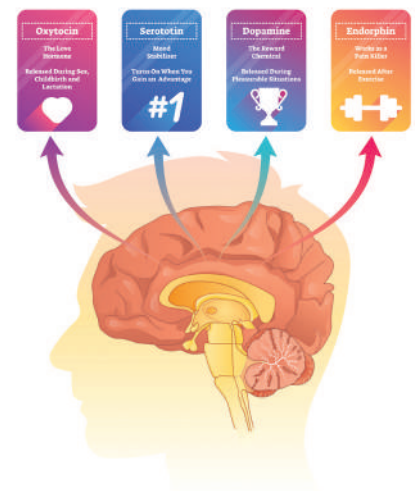
requires a certain level of focus and practice, kids learn to direct their movements and control their emotional energy.

Dance sparks a child's creativity

When kids learn new choreography, they also learn how to move their bodies and express themselves. Different forms of dance introduce them to new cultures and could inspire them to improvise their own steps and express their creativity further. Dance may also lead kids to discover other creative outlets



ENDORPHINS



such as art, music and theatre. It teaches them to think and move outside the box and unleash their imaginations.

Dance teaches perseverance and motivation to achieve new goals

As kids practise for their end-of-year dance recital, they learn perseverance and hard work. Dance is a perfect outlet that balances the freedom of movement with instructions and rules. Dance classes inspire kids to try new things and rehearse in order to achieve higher goals. If your child is struggling with

academics, dance can help them become self-motivated and self-disciplined.

Dancing encourages children to carry themselves better

Dancing is excellent for spinal strength and better deportment. Dancers are taught how to control their bodies to support their own weight optimally. If your child learns to dance, their posture will improve. They won't slouch and their back, shoulders, neck and limbs will benefit.



Dance improves balance

In line with the above, dancing also teaches better balance. Once a child learns how to hold themselves correctly, their entire stance improves. This keeps them centred and is necessary for their muscles and back. If one is more graceful, one is less prone to accidents and injury. Good posture is also important for appearance and presentation later in life.

Dancing improves flexibility

Though it may not seem like it, good physical flexibility plays an important role in our day-to-day lives. It improves motor skills and flexible bodies are capable

of withstanding more physical stress. Most dance styles are designed to improve body co-ordination, joint mobility, hip motion and muscular litnessness.

Dance teaches work ethics

In dance, there's often a goal one hopes to achieve. This could be as small as mastering a new step or dance sequence, or larger goals such as competing in an eisteddfod, festival or show, or taking an exam. The work ethic required to attain these goals teaches children that although some things may come easily, other objectives require hard work.



Dancing teaches resilience

Within dance, children will sometimes be challenged. It's essential that they keep trying, keep practising and don't give up. Dance teaches children to work hard and persevere.

Dance is a release

Dancing takes energy. Your child shouldn't be dancing to the point of exhaustion, but it's an outlet for pent-up hyperactivity and anxiety. This can also improve their sleep, concentration and general mood.

COMING IN THE WINTER ISSUE

SA HOMESCHOOLING
AND BEYOND'S 2023
DRAWING COMPETITION

SA Homeschooling and Beyond is an adventure and part of it is getting creative, using your imagination and enjoying every minute of the experience. And we're thrilled to bring you our latest adventure - our 2023 Drawing Competition.

This *SA Homeschooling and Beyond* initiative is aimed at encouraging children to express themselves through drawing, inspire creativity and encourage artistic skills.

The prize offerings are going to be FUNtastic and add even more excitement, fun and learning to your children's' homeschooling life!

Full entry details and rules will be published in our next issue (Winter issue).



Ask Dalena



Dalena van der Westhuizen will answer any questions or concerns you may have about learning, concentration, memory and cognitive development – and, of course, the frustrations arising from these

I'm a parent homeschooling my two children and have always struggled to concentrate and focus myself. Is this something that was never addressed or treated when I was younger? What exercises or tips could help me, as an adult? – Marina, Kempton Park

Hi Marina,

If a cognitive skill like attention isn't explicitly trained and strengthened, a child will continue to have attention struggles into adulthood. The article "7 Questions Answered About Your Child's ADHD" in [SAHS issue 9](#) contains lots of useful strategies. Here are two more:

1. Focus on one task at a time

Trying to do multiple things at the same time puts undue strain on the brain. Instead, start with a single task and finish it. Only then move on to the next.

2. Break down tasks and take regular breaks

Break tasks down into smaller, manageable (realistic) chunks to help you remain focused on the task at hand. *Tip:* Set a



timer for 25 minutes and start working. When time's up, take a five-minute break, then continue. Repeat until you're done.



My husband is German and I'm a South African whose mother tongue is English. It's important to both of us that our daughter learns and becomes fluent in both English and German. However, she's experienced some learning issues and we've been advised stick to English only when it comes to her studies. Do you agree and do you have any additional advice? – Nicole, Bryanston

Hi Nicole,

Since my area of expertise is cognitive development rather

than academics, I can only advise on the information the latest research into this topic offers.

There's overwhelming evidence that children learn best in and through the language they know best (known as *mother tongue*). During the early and primary school years, there's a big focus on communication and language skills development.

If that focus is centred around the language with which a child's most familiar, learning and development happen at a much faster pace.

You don't mention how old your child is. However, given the evidence supporting single-language education, I recommend taking the school's advice.

While your daughter may study and be schooled in English, you can still speak German at home, watch German movies, listen to German songs, etc.

My child has auditory processing issues. What's the best way of explaining work to him, or how else can I make learning easier for him? – Tracy, Pretoria

Hi Tracy,

Auditory processing involves the way the brain identifies incoming sounds, and is able to analyse those sounds and give them meaning (processing vs hearing).



It's one of the major underlying cognitive skills needed for reading and spelling, and in my experience working with auditory processing disorder (APD), it also affects the ability to pay attention and remain focused while listening or reading.

Here's what you can do:

1. Your son will have trouble understanding and remembering information when he hears it. **Keep explanations and instructions short and regularly ensure that he's keeping up.** Have him repeat the work/instruction back to you in his own words.
2. **Allow more time.** People with APD often experience a delay in their response to questions, so allow more time to process a question and formulate an answer.
3. People with APD get tired faster because listening is a cognitively taxing activity for them. **Keep learning sessions short, allow regular short**

About Dalena

Dalena van der Westhuizen is the co-founder and MD of BrainAbility, a cognitive development specialist, a master brain coach and an internationally certified cognitive coach. She translates the latest international cognitive research and best practice into strategies that can be applied by parents and educators alike.

A mom and a self-confessed chocoholic, Dalena enjoys working with both kids and adults to improve the way their brains process information for better learning, reading and focusing.



Send your questions for Dalena to: adri@isikhova.co.za.

breaks and schedule learning activities at the right time of day, as it may be harder for your son to listen and process that information in the late afternoon or evening when he's already tired.

4. **Consider cognitive training.** Modern brain research shows that cognitive skill weaknesses (such as auditory processing) can be identified and overcome. Cognitive skills training can restructure brain pathways to improve auditory processing.

UCT Online High School 2023 academic year starts off strong

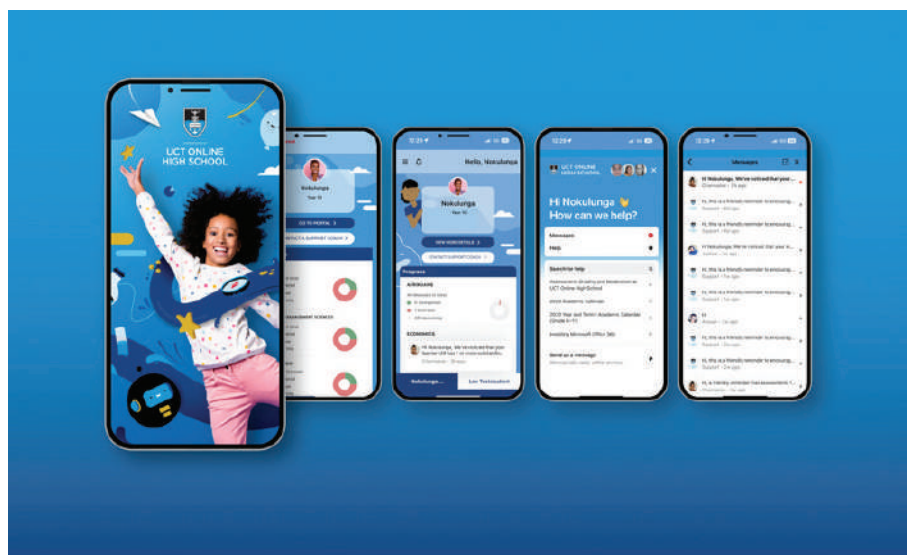
UCT Online High School has introduced a range of enhancements at the start of the new school year, including a first-of-its-kind guardian mobile app, a structured flexibility model, dynamic academic support and a gamification and rewards programme.

In July 2021, the University of Cape Town (UCT) announced the launch of [UCT Online High School](#), becoming the first university in Africa to extend its expertise and impact to the secondary schooling market through an innovative online education system. The university partnered with Cape Town based education technology company, Valenture Institute, to deliver an innovative, affordable online school, offering the CAPS curriculum in grades 8 to 12.

Furthering its product offering in August of 2022, it announced the addition of the Cambridge International Curriculum, touted as the most affordable Cambridge International qualification in Africa. After one full academic year, its first 2022 cohort of more than 4 000 learners across a range of grades, completed their studies.

Executive Head of School and Chief Academic Officer, Banele Lukhele, shares what the range of enhancements introduced at the start of this year entail.

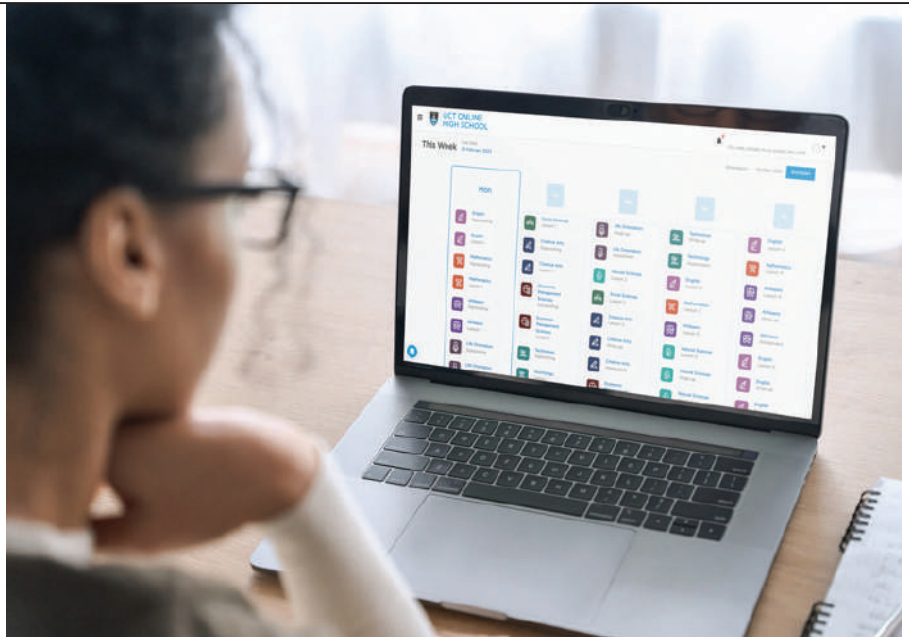
UCT Online High School launched its 'Connected' guardian (parent) mobile app at the start of the school year. Tell us more about the app. Yes, we are very excited about this addition to the range of enhancements that we have



rolled out and we have already seen that more than two thirds of our parents have downloaded the app. While there are many mobile apps on the market geared towards keeping parents informed of school updates, there are very few that provide a view into a learner's day-to-day learning analytics or that have been custom built to complement a school's unique approach to support. The app is intended to enhance the learner, parent and school triad and empower parents on this journey.

The features of the ConnectED app include:

- A data dashboard of a learner's module progress for the courses in which they are enrolled, including those that are completed, overdue or upcoming
- A view of assessments due this week
- Weekly summary report
- Internal Tests and Examinations Schedule
- The ability to launch a whatsapp conversation with a learner's Support Coach directly from the app
- Access to an Info Hub resource bank
- Push notifications to alert a parent if their child misses a deadline or requires intervention



What other enhancements have UCT Online High School introduced at the start of the school year?

- In 2023, we introduced stringent deadlines management and work plans on the learner's dashboard. This was in response to our observations that some learners need additional guidance with time management and prioritisation. This also responded to the feedback that learners and guardians would prefer a single view of the content that they need to cover over the week and across subjects.
- In addition to this, we introduced the gamification and rewards programme. Learning must be fun and it must be something that learners want to do. This programme has introduced that aspect into our model and we have seen learners really engage with this to date.

The school also introduced the concept of structured flexibility this year with weekly module release and weekly deadlines. As the end of the first term approaches, how has this helped learners in achieving results? Our 2023 academic year has really started off strong and our learners are progressing very well. The weekly structure has helped with expectation setting and has given great insights into grade and subject performance, as the majority of our learners are completing the work in the expected time. Having this data, also gives our academic team an opportunity to remediate common gaps within the grades in live sessions and through additional resources, which has created learning communities amongst our learners. A lot has come out of this shift and we look forward to seeing more insights as the year progresses.

Disappointing matric results?

When the annual matric results are released, not everyone gets to celebrate the end of a successful high school experience. Some matriculants find themselves excited to be starting their higher education journeys, while others feel very unsure of what to do next

“Failing matric isn’t the end of the world – don’t let it become a roadblock to your success. There are various options for pupils to consider if they’ve failed or aren’t satisfied with their marks,” says Vimala Ariyan, CEO of Star Schools.

The SA Depression and Anxiety Group (SADAG) reports that 9,5% of teen deaths in South Africa are caused by suicide. Disappointment at failing matric has been identified as one of the triggers. However, the good news is that there are plenty of alternatives for pupils who’re unsure of what to do next.

Options for those who’ve failed matric:

Consider the matric rewrite programme Whether you’ve failed, or are dissatisfied with your pass marks, you can rewrite and improve them at specific institutions. However, you aren’t allowed to

change any subjects: rather, you have to rewrite the subjects you wrote in your matric final exams. Fortunately, there’s no restriction on the number of times you can rewrite your matric.

“A number of pupils have chosen to do this and have achieved improved matric results,” says Vimala. “Many programmes, such as ours at Star Schools, have been extremely successful over the years, with many pupils gaining successful entry into higher education institutions. As a result, we encourage those who’ve failed their matric to take advantage of such programmes, rather than giving up.”

Re-do certain subjects

If you did poorly in one or more subjects, or if you haven’t been accepted to your desired institution or course because your marks didn’t meet the minimum requirements, you can consider upgrading them at specific institutions.

Request a remark If you’ve failed or are unhappy with your results and believe your marks need to be corrected, you can request a remark. However, this must be done within 21 days of



the Minister of Education's formal release of results. Even though it comes at a price, it may be beneficial to you, as you could find yourself with satisfactory results that get you into the institution of your choice.

Enrol for skill development

courses Skill development courses are ideal for getting a job or starting a business. They equip people with the skills and knowledge needed to be functional and resourceful in the work environment. This is perfect for youngsters who want to begin working as soon as possible. When you finish the short course, you'll receive a certificate qualification that you can use to become self-employed or get a job in other companies.

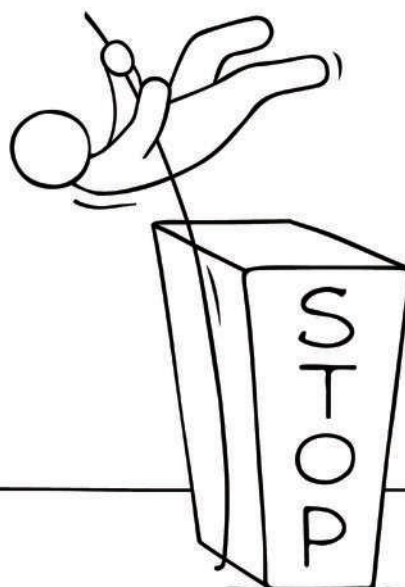
"A number of pupils who register for a matric rewrite programme do so in order to qualify for tertiary education."



Whatever you choose to do, don't assume that you did badly or failed because you're stupid or inadequate. Matric is a hurdle which you're required to clear in order to advance with your career or working choices – but it certainly isn't an indication of your abilities or your worth. Once you've gotten over the disappointment of your results, square up, resolve to try again and never forget that no matter who you are, your potential is infinite, provided you put in the effort and studying required.



Grade



'Home' in on homeschooling

GET YOUR BRAND'S
SHARE OF VOICE!

[Click here
to view and
download
Brand Card](#)

sa Homeschooling
and beyond

To make your brand booking,
contact Jenny Justus
011 883 4627 / 083 450 6052
jenny@isikhova.co.za





Adding 1

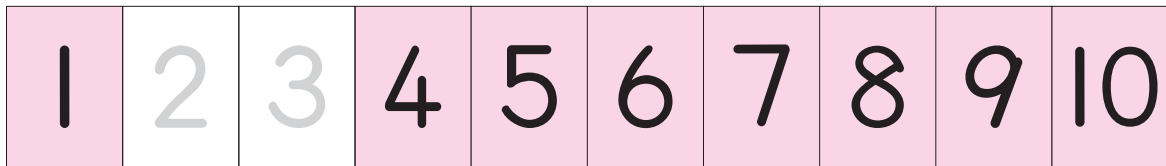
1 + 1 to 9 + 1

Name _____

Date ____/____/____

To parents: Please use the number chart to make sure your child understands that when you add 1 to a number, the result will be the next number.

- Fill in the missing numbers and then add the numbers below.

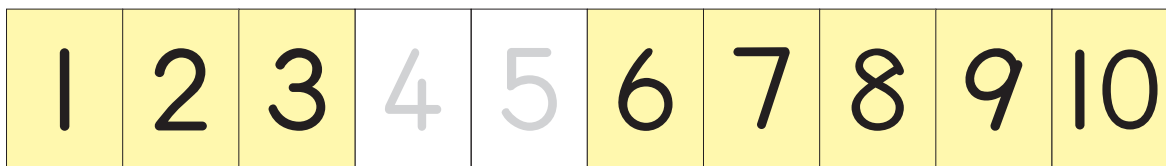


One Plus One Equals

$$1 + 1 = \boxed{2}$$

Two Plus One Equals

$$2 + 1 = \boxed{3}$$



Three Plus One Equals

$$3 + 1 = \boxed{4}$$

Four Plus One Equals

$$4 + 1 = \boxed{5}$$



Five Plus One Equals

$$5 + 1 = \boxed{6}$$

Six Plus One Equals

$$6 + 1 = \boxed{7}$$



- Fill in the missing numbers and then add the numbers below.

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	----

Four Plus One Equals

$$4 + 1 = \boxed{5}$$

Five Plus One Equals

$$5 + 1 = \boxed{6}$$

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	----

Six Plus One Equals

$$6 + 1 = \boxed{7}$$

Seven Plus One Equals

$$7 + 1 = \boxed{8}$$

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	----

Eight Plus One Equals

$$8 + 1 = \boxed{9}$$

Nine Plus One Equals

$$9 + 1 = \boxed{10}$$



Adding 1

1+1 to 10+1

Name _____

Date ____/____/____

To parents: If your child seems to be having difficulty, you can say something like, "This is 2+1. What's the next number after 2?"

■ Fill in the missing numbers and then add the numbers below.

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	----

(1) $1 + 1 = 2$

(4) $4 + 1 = 5$

(2) $2 + 1 = 3$

(5) $5 + 1 = 6$

(3) $3 + 1 = 4$

(6) $6 + 1 = 7$

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	----

(7) $7 + 1 = 8$

(10) $1 + 1 =$

(8) $8 + 1 = 9$

(11) $2 + 1 =$

(9) $9 + 1 = 10$

(12) $4 + 1 =$



■ Fill in the missing numbers and then add the numbers below.

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	----

(1) $1 + 1 =$

(4) $6 + 1 =$

(2) $3 + 1 =$

(5) $8 + 1 =$

(3) $4 + 1 =$

(6) $9 + 1 =$

1	2			5		7		9	10
11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20

(7) $10 + 1 = 11$

(10) $5 + 1 =$

(8) $2 + 1 =$

(11) $10 + 1 =$

(9) $3 + 1 =$

(12) $7 + 1 =$

Brand supporters



ACADEMIC COACHES

www.academiccoaches.co.za
info@academiccoaches.co.za
012 345 1540



BOSTON

www.bostononline.co.za
Janine@boston.co.za
011 551 9111



EZ LEARN

www.ezlearn.co.za
barbara@ezlearn.co.za
082 322 0005



BRAINABILITY

www.brainability.co.za
dalena@brainability.co.za
082 448 8221



CIRRUS HEALTHCARE

www.cirrus.shop
penny@chpsa.com
079 366 2553



MASKEW MILLER LEARNING

www.mml.co.za
Nosmilo.Mashwama@pearson.com
021 532 6000



BK PUBLISHING

www.bkpublishing.co.za
mail@bkpublishing.co.za
012 342 5347



DIGITUTORS

www.digitutors.co.za
admin@digitutors.co.za
082 604 7318



MOORE ACADEMY

www.moorehouse.co.za
amber@moorehouse.co.za
010 746 0236



BORN TO LEARN

www.borntolearn.co.za
info@borntolearn.co.za
082 560 6588



DT INTERNATIONAL ACADEMY

www.danieteach.com
info@danieteach.com
076 090 1016



PEARSON

www.za.pearson.com
christine.evans@pearson.com
021 532 6008



EDUC8SA

www.educ8sa.net
info@educ8sa.net
084 685 2138



VALENTURE INSTITUTE

www.valentureinstitute.com
enquiries@valentureinstitute.com
021 207 3894

CHALK ONE UP WITH

SA Homeschooling and Beyond's "CHALKBOARD!"

If you have your own homeschooling service whether it be social activities, caregiving services, gardening for kids programmes, extramurals, educational games/puzzles, outdoor activity programmes and the like, then SA Homeschooling's "Chalkboard" pages are the perfect way to get them promoted. And at an exceptionally affordable rate with fantastic exposure!



Find us on
Facebook
& Instagram

CONTACT US FOR
MORE INFORMATION

JENNY jenny@isikhova.co.za

THULI thuli@isikhova.co.za

sa Homeschooling
and beyond